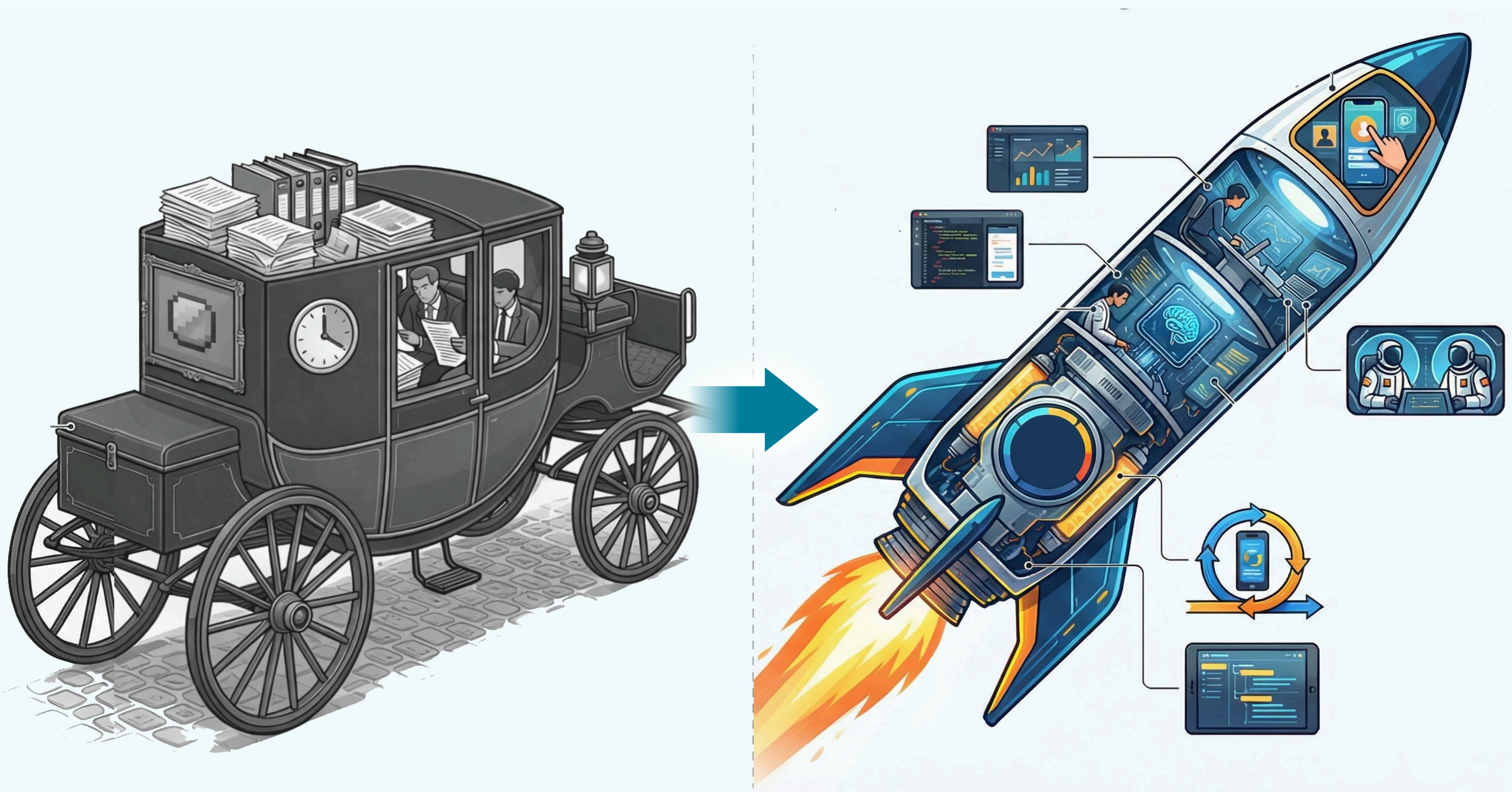
Pod Execution Model

The shortest distance between an idea and what ships.



Pods Eliminate the Translation Layers That Slow Delivery

THE NEW PARADIGM

01 **Iterate first. Spec later.**

02 **Roles collapse. Handoffs disappear.**

03 **AI fills the operational gaps that previously required headcount.**

Every Delivery Cycle Strengthens the Next Iteration

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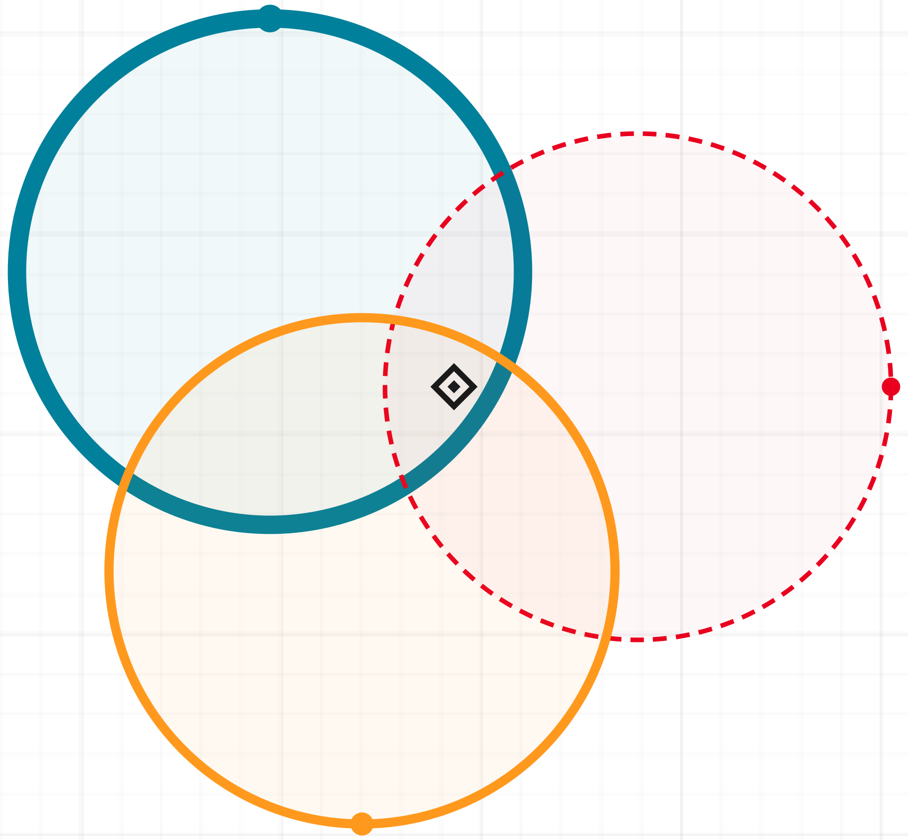
Execution becomes predictable when learning never stops.



01 Discover

Synthesize stakeholder signals, system context, and competitive inputs to define a differentiated solution direction.

DELIVERABLE: SIGNED-OFF DOCUMENTATION + PROMPT PACKAGE

02 Iterate

Iterate through working Canvas-driven iterations with same-day feedback and pre-code stakeholder alignment. Then build, integrate, and continuously test against acceptance criteria.

DELIVERABLE: VALIDATED ITERATION READY FOR PRODUCTION SCAFFOLDING

03 Launch

Ship to production users, run retrospective, capture learnings, and feed evidence back into the next Discover cycle.

DELIVERABLE: RELEASE + RETRO INTELLIGENCE REPORT

Two Operators Drive Each Pod Everyone Else Advises

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Execution cores, not committees. Built for speed and decisive action.

CORE OPERATORS

Engineer

Champion

AVAILABLE SUPPORT · ON DEMAND

UX

QA

PM

CS

Engineer and Champion drive the pod. Everyone else advises.

AI is the force multiplier. Every person commands unprecedented leverage.

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AI Collapses Roles, Replacing Sequential Handoffs with Shared Iteration

From passing documents over weeks to iterating in code over hours.

The Old Way: Silos

- ✗ PM writes specs for weeks
- ✗ Designer lives in Figma
- ✗ Engineer builds blindly from specs

Result: Context decays across slow phase gates.

The New Way: Iteration

- ✓ Anyone can shape the product
- ✓ Champion drafts clickable UI
- ✓ Engineer orchestrates AI codebase

Result: Zero handoffs. Teams of 10 become 3.

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Context Synthesis Replaces Multi-Week Spec Cycles

What used to require heavy manual synthesis now takes a morning with AI.

Gather Context

Dump transcripts, tickets, and signals straight into AI.

Output: Problem summary highlighting what's broken.

ChatGPT · Teams

Draft Documentation

Generate a tight 1-page spec focused purely on core flows.

Output: High-fidelity scope and constraints.

ChatGPT · Copilot

Define Done

Lock the exact criteria for what "shipped" means before building.

Output: Testable acceptance criteria.

ChatGPT · Copilot

Designers Ship Working UI in Hours, Not Weeks

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A designer with VS Code can produce a clickable artifact in a single session.

Shape the Brief

Pressure-test specs with UX thinking and find gaps using **AI**.

Output: UX-refined iteration brief.

ChatGPT · Copilot

Build in Code

Generate full, working interface views via plain language, no static mockups.

Output: Clickable, testable iteration.

VS Code · Opus 4.6 · Codex

Iterate Live

Refine live by prompting AI. Act as creative director, not a pixel pusher.

Output: Rapid live adjustments.

VS Code · Opus 4.6

Engineers Orchestrate AI, Not Write Every Line

Engineers direct, integrate, and ensure quality while AI handles the heavy lifting.

Scaffold the App

Point **AI** at the codebase to scaffold production code directly from UI drafts.

Output: Initial flows running in 48hrs.

VS Code · Opus 4.6 · Codex

Ship and Iterate

Automate boilerplate (tests, APIs, models) to shift focus from syntax to direction.

Output: Features shipped in minutes.

VS Code · Opus 4.6 · Codex

Own Architecture

Map integrations and use AI as a peer reviewer to catch blind spots early.

Output: Deployable structure Day 1.

ChatGPT · VS Code

QA Is Consultative, Not Gating. Stakeholders Clear the Path.

QA advises and automation covers the baseline. Stakeholders remove friction, not approve output.

QA Advisory

Act as scope consultants, not embedded gatekeepers. Use AI to generate test scenarios.

Output: Focus on edge cases, not manual execution.

ChatGPT VS Code

Automated Coverage

Baseline QA coverage is generated entirely by automation during the build.

Output: Tested alongside every code change.

VS Code Opus 4.6

Stakeholder Alignment

Provide fast yes/no answers on scope. Absorb org friction so the pod can ship. No committees.

Output: Strategic direction without blockers.

Every Artifact Must Accelerate Testing or Iteration

The artifact is the iteration. Everything else is a note to make the iteration better.

What Pods Don't Produce

- ✕ Multi-page spec documents
- ✕ Polished Figma handoff files
- ✕ Status decks or approval presentations
- ✕ Documentation drafted before the software works

What Pods Produce

- ✓ **Rapid Project Plan (RPP)** as the baseline
- ✓ Clickable, code-backed iterations
- ✓ AI-generated test checklists and edge cases
- ✓ Short decision logs instead of meetings

[MANDATORY PROTOCOL]

The RPP Is the Required Entry Point Before Any Pod Ships

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Seven fields. One page.
The foundation every pod builds against.

Problem
What problem are we solving right now?

Scope Boundary
What is explicitly out of scope?

Primary User
Who exactly runs the workflow?

Test Workflow
Exact capture-to-review flow.

Definition of Done
Operational · Usable · Demonstrable

Success Signal
What proves value quickly?

Owner | Champion responsible for execution.

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RPP in the Wild:
The Miami Dade Fast Track

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A real execution plan stripped of the noise. Focus entirely on reality and constraints.

EXECUTION CORE Jonathan CHAMPION Vlado ENGINEER

The Core Problem

Deep folder trees degrade performance for enterprise clients (~4000 folders). API workarounds are failing.

Aggressive Scope

Rip out legacy folder logic. Migrate entirely to the new domain permission model. Stabilize performance before touching UI.

Harsh Reality

The Euro engineering team owns the implementation but is resource constrained without external support.

Phased Execution

Phase 1 locks performance. Phase 2 introduces bulk editing UI. Phase 3 generalizes across the core enterprise.

Success

Deep folder structure and complex permission. mechanisms do not degrade platform performance.

The underlying artifact.

Miami Dade Fast Track

TL;DR

Stabilize File Manager performance for large folder structures by migrating folder permissions to the new domain permission model, then deliver bulk permission management to eliminate folder-by-folder edits.

Success = large projects load without degradation, admins modify permissions across thousands of folders efficiently.

What We're Shipping

- **Backend Architecture:** Migrate to new domain permission model
- **Performance Stabilization:** Eliminate deep folder permission crawl
- **UI Enhancement:** Bulk permission management workflow

Problem Breakdown

Performance

- Deep folder trees degrade performance
- Thousands of folders per project
- API workarounds do not scale

Usability

- Manual edits per folder required
- Miami Dade: ~4000 folders, ~75 groups
- Current UI not viable at enterprise scale

Goal

Ensure File Manager supports enterprise-scale folder structures without performance degradation while enabling efficient bulk permission management.

Scope — Phase 1: Performance

- Replace folder permission logic with new domain model
- Align folder architecture with partition-level permissions
- Validate performance on large data sets

Out of scope: usability enhancements before performance stabilization

Scope — Phase 2: Usability

- Introduce bulk permission editing workflow
- Enable cross-folder updates in a single action
- Ensure solution benefits all customers, not just Miami Dade

Core Technical Decisions

- Adopt onboarding rewrite permission model for folders
- Avoid API-based mass permission mutation
- Performance validation before UI improvements begin

Constraints & Trade-offs

- Euro engineering team owns implementation
- Euro team is resource constrained
- Performance must be solved before usability
- High-visibility customers involved
- No external engineering support for Euro team

Phased Plan

Phase 1: Define migration approach · Assign engineering ownership · Validate performance on large projects
Phase 2: Design bulk permission UX · Implement efficient update workflow · Test across Miami Dade and GSA
Phase 3: Generalize rollout across enterprise · Monitor performance and feedback

Stakeholders

- Engineering Architecture: Colin
- Implementation: Vlad and Euro Team
- API Context: Mike Richie
- Customer Success: Kimberly Day
- Partner Enablement: John Quigley

Shared Vocabulary:
Eliminating Misalignment

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Consistent terms prevent drift.
Every pod behaves the exact same way.

Pod 01

A small execution unit. Not a traditional team. A focused delivery core designed to move at the speed of decisions.

Champion 02

The single person closest to the problem who drives scope, removes blockers, and makes decisions. Accountable for what ships.

Advisor 03

Expertise (UX, PM, QA, Platform) contributing exactly when the pod needs it. Supports progress rather than gating it.

Rapid Project Plan 04

A short execution source of truth. Defines the problem, scope boundary, and definition of done. Extremely fluid.

Inputs 05

Raw context (transcripts, tickets, interviews) fed directly into AI. This permanently replaces sequential hand-off deliverables.

Iteration 06

A working representation of the workflow. The entire point is to get something in front of people fast to gather feedback.

Iteration Loop 07

Discover, Iterate, Validate, Ship, Repeat. The tempo explicitly adapts to the problem. Each pass rapidly accelerates.

Done 08

Operational and usable. A real user can successfully complete the core workflow. Does not mean fully polished or documented.

Demo 09

A working demonstration inside the real system. If it can't be shown genuinely working, it simply isn't ready.

Continuous Progress Beats Delayed Polish

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Speed doesn't come from working harder.
It comes from closing the feedback loop instantly.

Visible Progress

The working iteration advances continuously.

System-Level Feedback

Stakeholder reaction happens entirely inside the real system, not in abstract review meetings.

Cross-Pod Diffusion

Successful patterns spread immediately across all execution teams.

> Execution is the strategy. The pod that ships fastest teaches the org the most.

Done Means Operational.

~~Not Polished.~~

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What "Done" Means

Operational
The workflow executes end to end.

Testable
A real human can actively manipulate it.

Adoptable
A user can complete the primary job-to-be-done.

Demonstrable
It can be shown live in the system, not on slides.

What It Does Not Mean

~~Pixel Perfect~~
Visual polish is secondary to functional proof.

~~Fully Documented~~
The working system serves as the source of truth.

~~All Edge Cases Handled~~
We solve the core flow before hunting exceptions.

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Teams no longer operate around a PRD. They operate around an Iteration.

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CASE STUDY

kCapture Proves the Model

From an abstract concept to a shipping product without a single traditional handoff.

EXECUTION CORE ProCon CHAMPION Colin ENGINEER

ALREADY SHIPPED

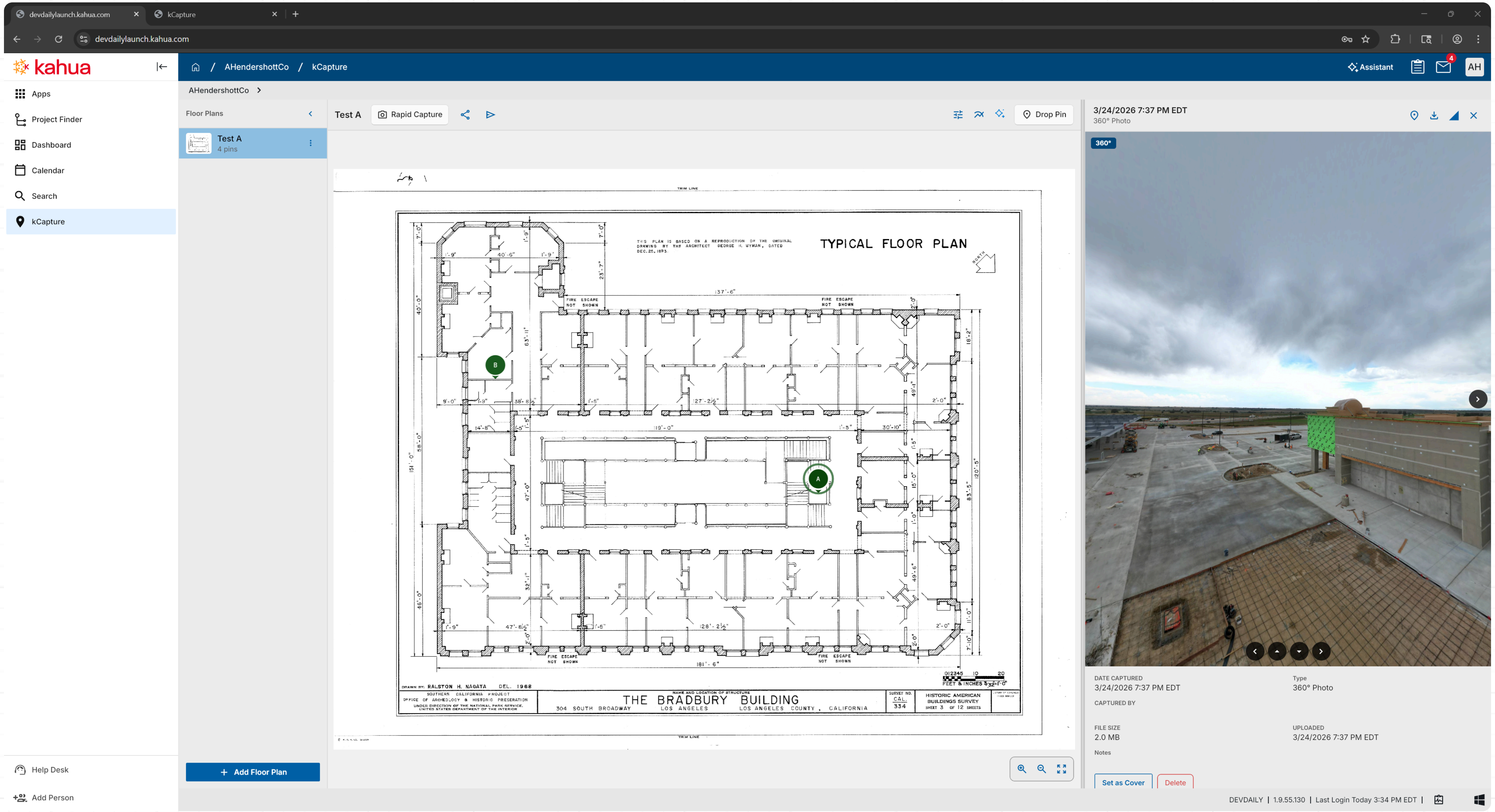
- Floor plans with persistent pins
- Capture timelines (photo, video, 360)
- Live mobile 360 panorama
- Offline-tolerant sync queue

WHAT IT PROVES

- Zero-training capture workflows
- Flawless automated pin binding
- Clear location-history traversal

> Spatial inspection over media storage. Capture attaches to place, not gallery.

CURRENT DRAFT · MAR 29, 2026 ↓ PDF



Canvas Validated the Execution Model

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The pilot pod. Canvas shipped as a full product using the execution framework before we even formalized it.

EXECUTION CORE Pritesh CHAMPION Colin ENGINEER

WHAT IT PROVED

- AI accelerated every phase of the development lifecycle.
- Stakeholder feedback evaluated completely within live iterations.
- Spec-first pipeline fully abandoned for: problem → iterate → ship.

> Canvas is the proven pattern. Subsequent pods scale it into standard.

One execution model.
Three proving grounds.

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01

VALIDATION SEQUENCE

Calendar Pod

EXECUTION CORE

Steve CHAMPION | Colin ENGINEER | Denny, Bridgette ADVISORS

- Proving surface for rapid execution on live workflows.
- Establishes pattern for Submittals, Inspections, and Closeout.
- The primary proving ground. Anchors org-wide expansion.

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02

VALIDATION SEQUENCE

Strategic Pod

EXECUTION CORE

Sakiba, Jonathan CHAMPIONS

Vlado ENGINEER

Brian Haines ADVISOR

- Strategic execution on AssetCentric PM expansion surfaces.
- Leverages existing app docs as fuel for immediate builds.
- Validates framework for core platform evolution.

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03

VALIDATION SEQUENCE

Forward Pod

EXECUTION CORE

Jordan CHAMPION | TBD ENGINEER | TBD ADVISORS

- Embeds directly with customers for live ground-truth execution.
- Real-time workflow discovery paired with instant implementation.
- Pending dedicated engineering support before full activation.

TIMELINE & ROLLOUT

Calendar pod is the pilot. Model expands post-May.

01

Right Now

Staff the Forward Deployed pod. Confirm all three core pod rosters.

02

Next Step

Cross-team alignment meeting. Calendar pod kicks off immediately after.

03

As Fast As Possible

Calendar pod ships a working iteration. Core model validated in production.

04

After May

Broader rollout begins. Calendar pilot becomes the definitive template.

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EXECUTION PROTOCOL

Six Concrete Behavior Shifts

These are not aspirational. These start now.

01 **Ship To Learn**
No more weeks of polish before learning. Ship unfinished but fully operational iterations.

02 **Same-Day Artifacts**
PMs ship a working iteration the same day they write documentation. Problem frames become live code.

03 **Designers in Code**
Designers move into VS Code. Final layout ships as working HTML structures, not static Figma frames.

04 **Engineers Direct AI**
Engineers direct AI logic instead of writing every line. Scaffolding, iteration, and testing are accelerated.

05 **Embedded QA**
QA is everyone's job, organically embedded from day one. There is no rigid downstream handoff.

06 **Centralized Artifacts**
Pod execution pacing, coordination, and live prototype tracking are owned and monitored centrally.

APPENDIX

Pod Execution System

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Engineer & Champion
Are Constant. All Others Flex.

No downstream handoffs. The entire pod is active in every phase. Highlighted cells indicate **execution drivers**, while faint cells represent active support.

ROLE	DISCOVER	ITERATE	BUILD	LAUNCH
EXECUTION DRIVERS (100% EMBEDDED)				
Engineer	Tech Feasibility	Rapid Scaffolding	**Code end-to-end**	**Deploy**
Champion	**Lock Scope**	Stakeholder Demo	Unblock Team	**Sign off**
ADVISORY SUPPORT (SCALE AS NEEDED)				
PM *	**Document**	**Validate Focus**	Cut Scope Creep	Comms
Designer *	User Research	**States & Flows**	**VS Code Layout**	Visual QA
QA *	Test Strategy	Acceptance Criteria	**Continuous testing**	**Regression**

Single-Customer Insights Become Platform Capabilities.

Pods execute highly specific, local workflows. When local patterns overlap across multiple pods, that validated insight graduates back into the core platform for everyone.

01 THE POD LEVEL

Local R&D

A single Pod rapidly builds, tests, and validates a hyper-specific workflow directly with one real customer.

02 THE NETWORK LEVEL

Market Signal

Multiple pods independently detect the exact same workflow pattern and need emerging across different customers.

03 THE GLOBAL LEVEL

Platform Scale

The proven workflow is extracted, standardized, and permanently deployed as a core Kahua platform capability.

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PRODUCT MANAGER

THE OLD WAY

~~Spec Author~~

- Spends weeks writing detailed PRDs
- Delays engineering for requirements
- Measures success by document volume

THE NEW WAY

Decision Scientist

The PM's absolute value is judgment and velocity. Dictate the flow, synthesize the context, and rely on real validation instead of static specifications.

Live Iteration
Define problem frames entirely inside working UI models on day one.

Instant Synthesis
Pipe all customer signals directly into Canvas to synthesize architecture immediately.

Real Validation
Force users to interact with live workflows instead of reviewing static ideas.

PRODUCT DESIGNER

THE OLD WAY

~~Pixel Pusher~~

- Spends weeks drawing static mockups
- Delivers untested redline annotations
- Forces disconnected handoff cycles

THE NEW WAY

Creative Director

Design accelerates iteration instead of preceding it. You direct output logic and shape fully interactive features, eradicating static files entirely.

Live Prototyping

Open the codebase directly and command AI to scaffold interactive UI.

Output Curation

Direct the generated logic flow instead of manually aligning pixels.

Native Handoff

Abandon Figma links and ship functional logic natively alongside engineers.

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SOFTWARE ENGINEER

THE OLD WAY

~~Manual Coder~~

- ✕ Waits for visual mockups to begin
- ✕ Spends months typing boilerplate
- ✕ Gates code review until phase completion

THE NEW WAY

AI Orchestrator

The engineer's value is system orchestration and supreme judgment, not physical keystrokes.

Deep Scaffolding

Generate the core architectural infrastructure instantly using massive context prompts.

Total Ownership

Assume immediate control of environments, component architecture, and CI integrations.

Rapid Velocity

Deliver end-to-end, functional user flows in staging within a 48 hour span.

QUALITY ASSURANCE

THE OLD WAY

~~Gatekeeper~~

- Waits for engineering to declare "done"
- Follows manual, fragile regression plans
- Acts as an adversarial release gate

THE NEW WAY

Embedded Partner

Validation is continuous and automated natively. There is no concept of an adversarial "handoff to QA" at the finish line.

Day One Entry

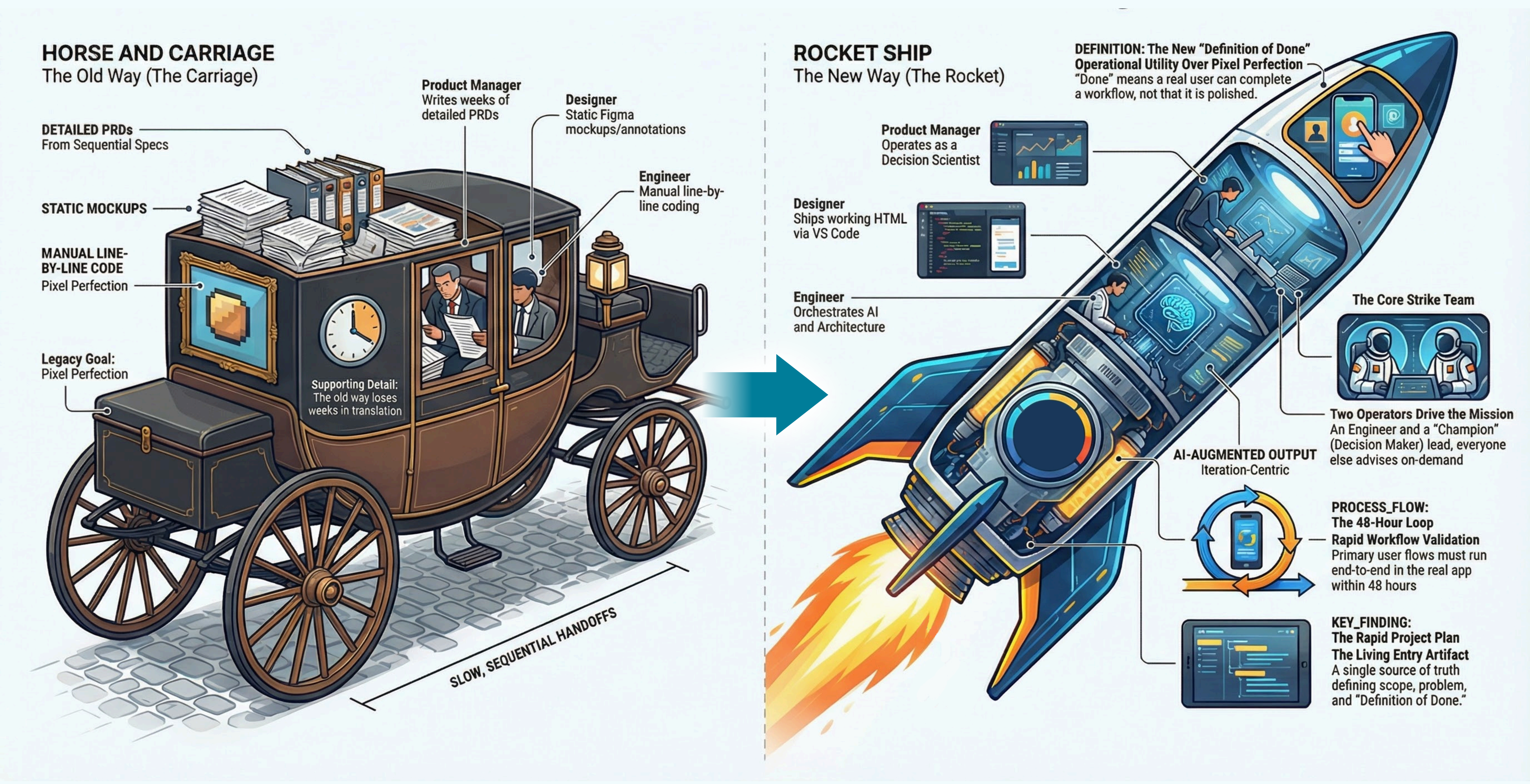
Merge into the iteration cycle at phase zero to establish safety bumpers.

Multi-Agent Scenarios

Orchestrate autonomous AI agents capable of relentlessly blitzing edge cases.

Velocity Enablement

The core objective shifts from artificially blocking builds to massively accelerating deployment.


HORSE AND CARRIAGE
The Old Way (The Carriage)
DETAILED PRDs
From Sequential Specs
STATIC MOCKUPS
MANUAL LINE-BY-LINE CODE
Pixel Perfection
Legacy Goal:
Pixel Perfection
Product Manager
Writes weeks of detailed PRDs
Designer
Static Figma mockups/annotations
Engineer
Manual line-by-line coding
Supporting Detail:
The old way loses weeks in translation
SLOW, SEQUENTIAL HANDOFFS
ROCKET SHIP
The New Way (The Rocket)
DEFINITION: The New "Definition of Done"
Operational Utility Over Pixel Perfection
"Done" means a real user can complete a workflow, not that it is polished.
Product Manager
Operates as a Decision Scientist
Designer
Ships working HTML via VS Code
Engineer
Orchestrates AI and Architecture
The Core Strike Team
Two Operators Drive the Mission
An Engineer and a "Champion" (Decision Maker) lead, everyone else advises on-demand
AI-AUGMENTED OUTPUT
Iteration-Centric
PROCESS_FLOW:
The 48-Hour Loop
Rapid Workflow Validation
Primary user flows must run end-to-end in the real app within 48 hours
KEY_FINDING:
The Rapid Project Plan
The Living Entry Artifact
A single source of truth defining scope, problem, and "Definition of Done."

↓ PDF

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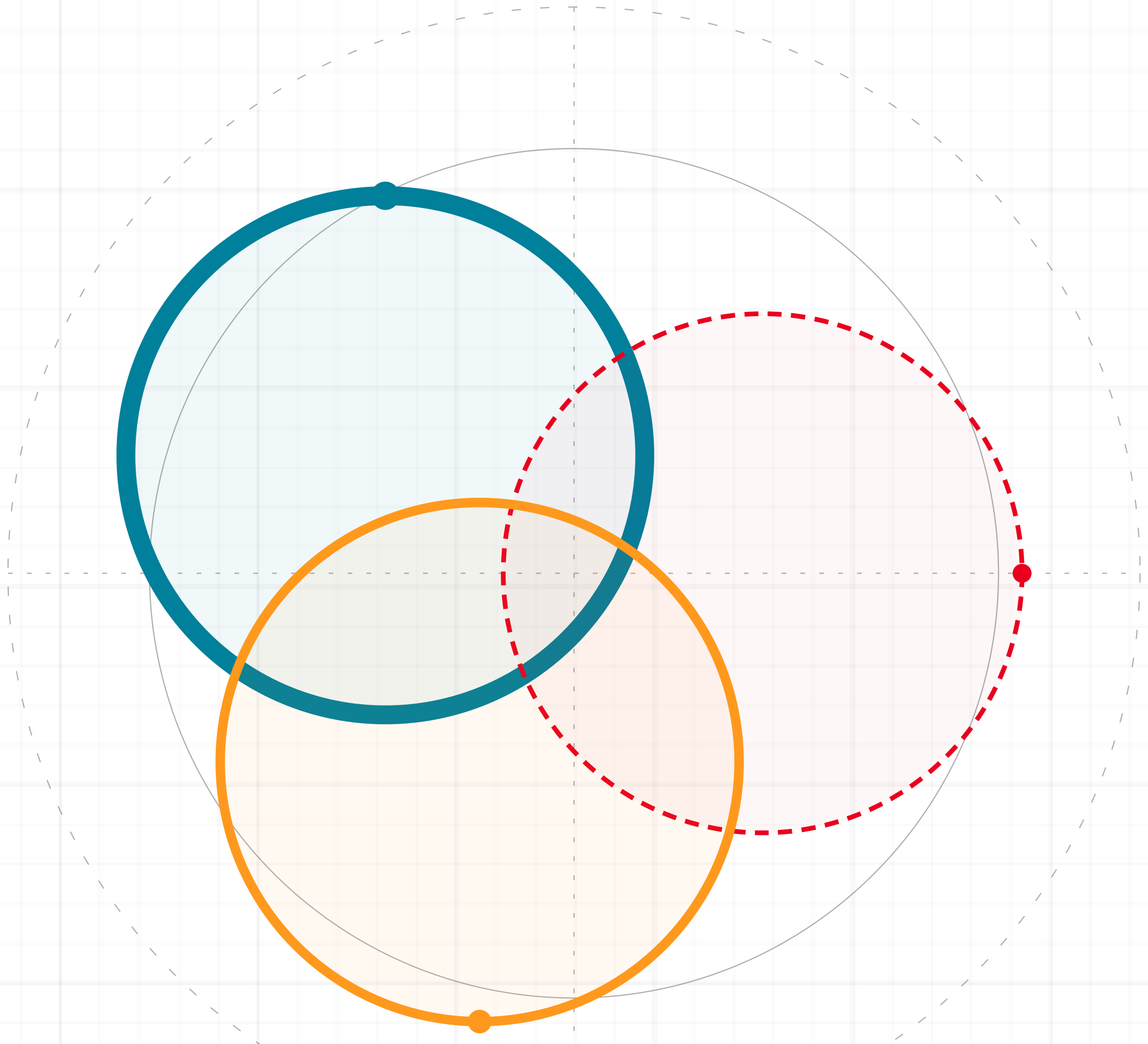

CURRENT DRAFT

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